

INTRODUCTION TO BUSINESS INFORMATION SYSTEMS (INF1505)

WEEKLY SCHEDULE FOR THE YEAR 2026

The schedule is intended to help you pace your studies. Please note the due date for all assignments; no exceptions will be made for late submissions.

NOTES:

1. Please read section 9.1 of tutorial letter 101 about the availability of assignments. The assignments will be available a few days before the due dates.

If you miss a deadline, you have effectively forfeited that portion of your year mark.

The book prescribed for 2026 is MIS 11th edition. And it is available at bookshops. But you can still buy MIS 12th edition, if it is the edition you find in the store. MIS 12th is latest edition.

WEEK (2026)	CHAPTER/Module	LEARNING OBJECTIVES/ OUTCOMES	ASSESSMENT
1 (30th March)	1. Introduction to Information Systems	• LO1 Discuss common applications of computers and information systems. • LO2 Explain the differences between computer literacy and information literacy. • LO3 Define transaction processing systems. • LO4 Define management information systems. • LO5 Describe the four major components of an information system. • LO6 Discuss the differences between data and information. • LO7 Explain the importance and applications of information systems in functional areas of a business. • LO8 Analyze how information technologies are used to gain a competitive advantage.	

		• L09 Apply the Five Forces Model and strategies for gaining a competitive advantage. • L10 Review the IT job market. • L11 Summarize the future outlook of information systems.	
2 (6 th April)	2. Computers and Their Business Applications	• L01 Define a computer system and describe its components. • L02 Discuss the history of computer hardware and software. • L03 Analyze the impact of the three factors distinguishing computing power of computers. • L04 Summarize the three basic computer operations. • L05 Discuss the types of input, output, and memory devices. • L06 Explain how computers are classified and their business applications. • L07 Apply knowledge of the two major types of software and their use in a business setting. • L08 List the five generations of computer languages. • L09 Define object-oriented programming.	
3-4 (13 th April)	3. Data and Business Intelligence	• L01 Define a database and a database management system. • L02 Explain logical database design and the relational database model. • L03 Define the components of a database management system. • L04 Summarize recent trends in database design and use. • L05 Analyze the four major components and functions of a data warehouse and their use for business. • L06 Describe the functions of a data mart. • L07 Explain business analytics and describe its role in the decision-making process. • L08 Examine the advantage and challenges of big data and predictive analytics for a business. • L09 Explain database marketing and its business applications. • L010 Explain key features of Tableau and Power BI as two popular business intelligence and visualization platforms.	Assignment 01 available for submission on the 24 th April 2026
5-6 (28 th April)	4. Personal, Legal, Ethical, and	• L01 Discuss information privacy and methods for improving the privacy of information. • L02 Explain the general data protection regulation.	Assign 01 Official Due Date: 5 th May 2026

	Organizational Issues	• LO3 Explain the privacy issues of e-mail and data collection in a business setting. • LO4 Examine the ethical issues and censorship of information technology. • LO5 Discuss the principles of intellectual property and issues related to the infringement of intellectual property. • LO6 Examine the impact of information technology on society: the digital divide, telecommuting, and health issues. • LO7 Describe green computing and the ways it can improve the quality of the environment.	
7-8 (12 th May)	5. Protecting Information Resources	• LO1 Understand cybercrime and its impact on the global economy. • LO2 Describe information technologies that could be used in computer crimes. • LO3 Describe basic safeguards in computer and network security. • LO4 Identify the nine most common intentional security threats. • LO5 Describe the nine security measures and enforcement that a comprehensive security system should include. • LO6 Summarize the guidelines for a comprehensive security system, including business continuity planning	
09-10 (26 th May)	6. Data Communication: Delivery Information Anywhere and Anytime	• LO1 Describe major applications of a data communication system. • LO2 Explain the major components of a data communication system. • LO3 Describe the three major types of processing configurations. • LO4 Explain the three types of networks. • LO5 Describe the five main network topologies. • LO6 Explain important network concepts, such as bandwidth, routing, routers, and the client/server model. • LO7 Describe wireless and mobile technologies and networks. • LO8 Describe networking trends such as Wi-Fi, WiMAX, and Bluetooth • LO9 Discuss the importance of wireless security and the five techniques used. • LO10 Summarize the convergence phenomenon and its applications for business and personal use	Assignment 02 is available for submission on the 1 st June 2026

11-13 (8 th June)	7. A connected World	• LO1 Describe the makeup of the Internet and the Web. • LO2 Discuss navigational tools, search engines, and directories. • LO3 Describe four common Internet services and how they are used in a business environment. • LO4 Explain business applications of the Internet. • LO5 Describe the role intranets in various business functions. • LO6 Describe the role extranets in various business functions. • LO7 Analyze Web trends and their impact on business. • LO8 Analyze the Internet of Everything and its business applications.	Assign 02 Official Due Date: 17 th June 2026
14-16 (29 th June)	8. E-Commerce	• LO1 Define e-commerce, and describe its advantages, disadvantages, and business models. • LO2 Explain the major categories of e-commerce. • LO3 Describe the five major activities of the business-to-consumer e-commerce cycle. • LO4 Summarize the four major models of business-to-business e-commerce. • LO5 Describe mobile-based and voice-based e-commerce. • LO6 Explain four supporting technologies for e-commerce. • LO7 Explain social commerce and the reasons for its popularity. • LO8 Explain hypersocial organizations and their growing popularity. • LO9 Explain social media information systems.	
17- 18 (21 st July)	10. Building Successful information systems	• LO1 Apply the systems development life cycle (SDLC) as a method for developing information systems. • LO2 Explain the tasks involved in the planning phase. • LO3 Explain the tasks involved in the requirements-gathering and analysis phase. • LO4 Explain the tasks involved in the design phase. • LO5 Explain the tasks involved in the implementation phase. • LO6 Explain the tasks involved in the maintenance phase. • LO7 Describe new trends in systems analysis and design, including service-oriented architecture, rapid application development, extreme programming, and agile methodology.	Assignment 03 available for submission on the 29 th July 2026

19-20 (4 th August)	11. Enterprise Systems	• LO1 Explain how supply chain management is used within an organization. • LO2 Describe customer relationship management systems. • LO3 Describe knowledge management systems. • LO4 Describe enterprise resource planning systems • LO5 Explain advantages and disadvantages of cloud-based enterprise systems.	Assign 03 Official Due Date: 11 th August 2026
21- 22 (17 th Aug)	12. Supporting Decisions and Processes	• LO1 Examine the types of decisions made in each phase of the decision-making process. • LO2 Describe a decision support system. • LO3 Explain an executive information system's importance in decision making. • LO4 Summarize the uses for a geographic information system. • LO5 Describe collaboration systems or software including their types and criteria for their selection. • LO6 Apply the eight guidelines for designing a management support system.	
23-25 (31 st August)	13. Artificial Intelligence and Automation	• LO1 Define <i>artificial intelligence</i> and explain how AI technologies support decision making. • LO2 Describe an expert system, its applications, and its components. • LO3 Describe case-based reasoning, including the four Rs involved in its design and implementation. • LO4 Summarize each of the four types of intelligent agents and how they are used. • LO5 Describe fuzzy logic and its uses. • LO6 Explain machine learning and artificial neural networks. • LO7 Describe how genetic algorithms are used. • LO8 Explain natural-language processing and its major categories. • LO9 Describe the five benefits of integrating AI technologies into decision support systems. • LO10 Explain contextual computing. • LO11 Explain the AI impacts on automation. • LO12 Describe the ethical issues of AI.	Assignment 04 available for submission on the 07 th of September 2026

26-27 (22 nd Sept)	14. Emerging Trends, Technologies, and Applications	• LO8 Outline criteria for the ethical use of information systems. • LO1 Summarize new trends in software and service distribution. • LO2 Describe virtual reality components and applications. • LO6 Describe the foundation, models, and applications of cloud computing. • LO3 Discuss uses of nanotechnology. • LO4 Describe blockchain technology and cryptocurrency. • LO5 Explain quantum computing and its applications.	Assign 04 Official Due Date: 14 th September 2026
28 (5 th Oct)	Self Assessments may be provided: Chapter 1-8 & 10 -14	REVISION WEEK	
29 (12 th October – Exam)	Exams commence	Last day of assignment submissions is first week of October 2026 Exam start on the 12th October 2026 Tuition starting 30th March 2026, if registration is officially closed.	Exam commence <i>Exam Commence: Oct/Nov 2026</i>

© UNISA 2026